

Wansoo Choi

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EDUCATION

University at Buffalo, Buffalo, New York 2021 – 2027 (expected)
PhD Candidate in Finance, School of Management

Johns Hopkins University, District of Columbia 2019
Master of Science in Applied Economics

University at Albany, Albany, New York 2017
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (Financial Analyst Honors Program)
Undergraduate Honors Thesis: “The Impact of Leverage on Hedge Fund Performance”

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Market Microstructure, Retail Trade Classification, Hedge Fund Activism, Options

WORKING PAPERS

Market Quality of Informed Trades

with Juha Joenväärä, Dominik Rösch, and Cristian Tiu

Abstract: We investigate prices around timestamped informed trades using approximately 500,000 13D transactions from activist investors matched to TAQ trades. Activists are more price sensitive than non-activists and are more likely to attempt to hide their trading by strategically choosing when and how to trade. Activists have lower execution quality, higher price impact, and lower realized spreads, suggesting that activists, on average, fail to hide among the uninformed. Activists with less information (as measured by lower returns) are better at hiding (that is, they have better execution quality). These results are reversed for hedge funds: hedge funds with better execution quality generate higher returns.

Selected Presentations: Southern Finance Association (November 2026, scheduled); Financial Management Association (October 2026, scheduled); Northern Finance Association (September 2026, scheduled); Asian Finance Association (July 2026); Eastern Finance Association (March 2026); Southwestern Finance Association (March 2026, co-author); Annual Hedge Fund Research Conference (Poster, January 2026); The University of Melbourne (November 2025, co-author); Conference on Financial Economics and Accounting (November 2025); Hanyang University (May 2025, co-author); University at Buffalo Celebration of Student Excellence (2025); University at Buffalo School of Management Brown Bag (2025); University at Buffalo School of Management PhD Showcase (2025, 2024); University at Buffalo Institute for Artificial Intelligence and Data Science (2024)

Assessing the Reliability of Retail Trade Classification: Evidence from the Tick Size Pilot

solo-authored

Abstract: This paper uses the SEC’s Tick Size Pilot (TSP) to identify errors in retail trade classification. Tick sizes normally restrict quotes but not trades, so whether sub-tick executions are exclusive to retail remains unclear, although retail classification algorithms assume so. In Group 2, the TSP restricted trade prices to the five-cent grid with a retail exemption, making sub-tick executions largely retail-driven. Excess retail classifications in Groups 1 and Control relative to Group 2 identify false positives. Difference-in-differences estimates reveal excess off-exchange classifications—about 10 pp in Group 1 and 12 pp in Control—implying a false discovery rate near 75%.

Selected Presentations: Southern Finance Association (November 2026, scheduled); Eastern Finance Association (March 2026), Southwestern Finance Association (March 2026), University at Buffalo School of Management (2025)

How to: Dynamic Reports and Reproducible Research

with Toghrul Aghbabali, Taihun Im, Dominik Rösch, and Prince Roy

Abstract: We propose a framework to generate dynamic reports and make reproducible research easier. Motivated by growing concerns about the lack of reproducibility and replicability, nowadays, most journals ask authors to post their programming code. While beneficial to others, these policies seem costly to the original authors. Using a combination of freely available tools, we illustrate our framework with a case study in asset pricing. We demonstrate how research can be conducted with replicability in mind, significantly lowering costs and increasing benefits for the original authors.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, MGF 402 Investment Management, University at Buffalo Spring 2026

- Taught undergraduate Investment Management, covering core topics in asset pricing, portfolio theory, and derivatives.
- Designed a stock valuation project covering cost of equity, cost of debt, and equity valuation.
- Received an overall instructor rating of 4.3/5.0 with an 85% response rate.

SCHOLARSHIPS

- E. Han Kim Doctoral Fellowship (University at Buffalo) November 2025
- Dr. Robert F. Berner Doctoral Fund (University at Buffalo) November 2025
- Joseph A. Alutto Fellowship (University at Buffalo) Awarded 2021 – 2025
- Alumni of Professor Ronald Forbes Scholarship (University at Albany) November 2016

WORK EXPERIENCE

Republic of Korea Army – Sergeant, Incheon, South Korea 2012 – 2014
Intelligence (S2)

Oxford University Press Seoul Branch – Marketing Assistant, Seoul, South Korea 2012

TECHNICAL / LANGUAGE SKILLS

Programming: R, SQL, Python, SAS, Stata, MATLAB

Tools: LaTeX, OneTick, Microsoft Office

Language: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

REFERENCES

Dominik Rösch (Chair)

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